

Beat Sheet

Map the eight load-bearing moments of your story before you draft.

TITLE _____ GENRE _____ TARGET WORD COUNT _____

0%

Opening Image

A snapshot of the world and the flaw before anything changes. The "before" photo you will mirror at the end.

10%

Catalyst

The event that breaks normal. It happens to the protagonist; they do not choose it, and they cannot undo it.

20%

Break Into Two

The protagonist chooses to act and enters a new world. The door closes behind them: no going back.

50%

Midpoint

A false victory or false defeat flips the story. Stakes rise and the real game is revealed.

75%

All Is Lost

The worst moment. The plan is dead, and often something, or someone, is truly lost.

80%

Dark Night of the Soul

The protagonist sits in the wreckage and finally finds the lesson that was there all along.

80 TO 99%

Finale

Armed with the truth, they face the conflict head on and win in a way page one could never have managed.

100%

Final Image

The "after" photo. Mirror the opening image to prove the change is real and earned.